Graphic Design

Advanced Photo Manipulation

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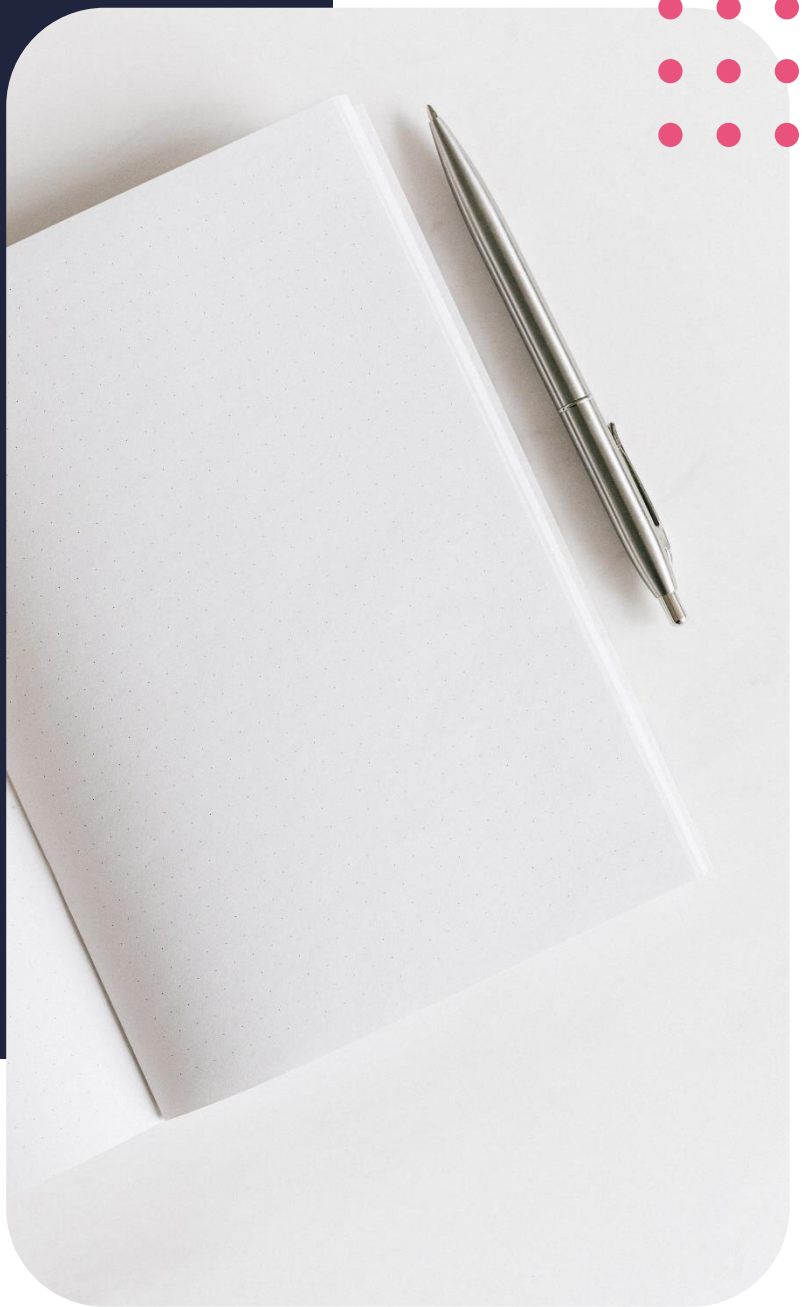


Lesson outcomes

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to:

- Lesson outcome 1: Graphic designers working as photo editors
- Lesson outcome 2: Graphic designers working with photographers: Raw images
- Lesson outcome 3: Some more techniques on photo manipulation

Introduction

Moving back to Photoshop, we will have a look at more amazing photo editing and manipulation techniques in the form of a couple of demos today. So, buckle up, this lesson is going to be practical.

Did you know that Photoshop was developed back in 1987 by brothers Thomas & John Knoll? Photoshop initially only displayed grayscale images and was originally called Display. Eventually the program got renamed ImagePro, but this name was already taken, and the Knoll brothers dubbed it Photoshop in 1988.

Jessica Hische is a hand-letterer and logotype designer who has also worked with Penguin books. Yes, design is fun, but it is also extremely hard work. Jessica states that to be a good artist or designer, it takes practice. A lot of it. More than you can even fathom when you're starting out.

So, with this quote, I would like you to really understand that when you make a career of this, if you have not started already, this is only the beginning – it is extremely hard work, like most successful careers in this world, but remember the first day you thought you were working hard – because one day, you will realise that you can work even harder.

Graphic designers as photo editors

One thing that you should understand when it comes to working with Photoshop specifically, is that you use it in different ways depending on the purpose of the project at hand. What this means is that when using Photoshop from a graphic design perspective, you will make use of other tools and features than what a photographer or animator for example would use. So, it is a good idea to broaden your knowledge on working with Photoshop from different perspectives.

A lot of graphic designers have become professional photo editors, since photographers might not have the time or knowledge (which is not likely) to enhance their images.

Experienced photo editors are in high demand and these editors can get paid quite a lot. This is normally what they do for a living, so if you are keen on office work all day, quarantined in your space for when a novel virus breaks out (no pun intended), this is a great job to have.

Photographers share their work via cloud storage or any other digital means, so you don't even need to get into contact with someone.

Being a photo editor, you will need to have your computer screen calibrated in order to make sure your colours are as accurate as possible.

Graphic designers working with photographers: Raw images

If photo editing is something you are interested in, then listen up as you will need to know the lingo for this career. If you are not keen on photo editing, then you should also listen up because somewhere along the line, you will encounter editing in some form or another.

First, we need to understand that most professional photographers take pictures in RAW format. A RAW image is called this due to the image still needed to be processed and edited, hence, it is still “raw”.

Photographs are taken in this RAW format since they possess a wider colour gamut and also preserve all the capture information at the time the image was taken making these files quite big in file size. You cannot change these details in a RAW file.

To edit a RAW file, you will need to have the necessary software to do so. Thus, you will need software like Photoshop or Lightroom to access these files. These are primarily photo editing software and taught in our Photography course.

When RAW images are edited, in for example Photoshop or Lightroom, it will be accompanied by an xmp file in the folder where the image is stored. This xmp file contains all the editing data made to the RAW image.

When the xmp file is deleted, you will lose all the enhancements made to the RAW file and it will return to its original state. Thus, you will never be able to manipulate a RAW file directly, but your manipulation will be stored as an xmp file that accompanies your RAW file.

In our first demo for this lesson, we will look at enhancing RAW images making use of Adobe’s Camera Raw software that accompanies Photoshop. Kindly note that in order to enhance and edit a RAW file, your software needs to be updated, since if the software is older than the camera the image was taken with, in most cases, you will not be able to edit this RAW image.

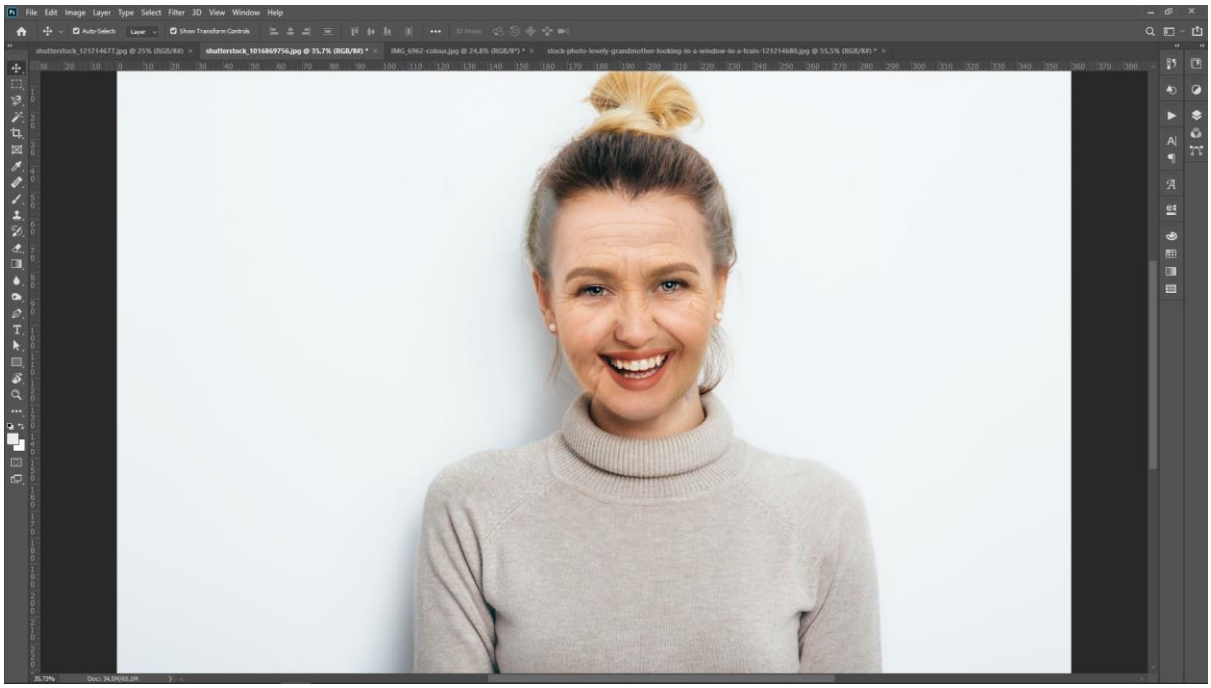
Our first demo entails editing a RAW image in Adobe’s Camera Raw editor.

(Please refer to video lesson for demo)

Techniques on photo manipulation

If you would like to practice editing Raw images and don't have a professional camera, there might be a change that your smartphone can take Raw images. Just double check under your camera settings.

Moving on. I would like to show you more advanced editing techniques in Photoshop. I have two very exciting demos for your lined up. First, we are going to manipulate a person's face to resemble an old person and secondly, I will be taking a photograph of a static car and create the illusion of it moving.



(Please refer to video lesson for demo)

(Please refer to video lesson for demo)

Avoid default fonts on your computer and rather download fonts. Just remember that if you would like more uniqueness and authenticity to your designs, you will most probably pay for a typeface and even adjust it to make it even more authentic. Especially when you use it for logo designing. But just don't use the default typefaces that came with

The Coca-Cola logo was merely a handwritten typeface back in the day and was thus used as such.

Conclusion

Ending off, I would like to reiterate our quote we did in the beginning of the lesson by Jessica Hische. I am sure that if you got this far in your graphic design diploma, you are committed and understand the process of practicing the skills you learn.

This is the steppingstone you have been wanting to get access into the world of graphic design. I personally can teach you awesome tips and all the tricks, but if you don't put the effort in, you will not bear the fruit.

It took me more than a decade to get where I'm now, so don't denounce yourself if you struggle as these hardships will only make you better if you persist.

Today entailed advanced photo manipulation techniques ranging from being a professional photo editor working alongside photographers.

We looked at editing RAW images using Adobe's Camera Raw function that you get with Photoshop. After this, we looked at other amazing tricks on manipulating images in Photoshop, from manipulating a young person's face to look like an old person and how to make it seem as though a static car is moving.

References

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